

Data sources

This file provides the metadata related to the data sources used for Australia in the Human Multiple Births Database (<https://www.twinbirths.org/en/data-metadata/>).

Summary

Data from 1907 to 1936:

Source: Bunle, H. (1954). *Le mouvement naturel de la population dans le monde de 1906 à 1936*. Paris: Les éditions de l'Institut national d'études démographiques (INED).

Coverage and completeness:

- Data only include the confinements where at least one child was born alive.
- Data exclude the Aboriginal population.

Treatment of births by vitality:

- The deliveries resulting in stillborn children only are not included. A multiple delivery is counted only if at least one child was born alive.

Data from 1938 to 2020:

Source: Australian Bureau of Statistics (ABS)

Coverage and completeness:

- Data only include the confinements where at least one child was born alive.
- Until 1966, data exclude the Aboriginal population.
- Data refer to births that occurred and were registered in Australian territory, regardless of citizenship or residence status of the parents. Births to Australian nationals employed overseas at Australian legations and consular offices are also included.
- Each State and Territory has an independent system of registration; there may be differences between States/Territories in the registration procedures for births.
- Due to registration lags, data are presented by year of registration instead of year of occurrence.

Treatment of births by vitality:

- Data include only the confinements where at least one child was born alive (i.e., the confinements resulting in stillborn children only are excluded). A multiple birth is a confinement which results in two or more children, at least one of which is live-born.

Detailed metadata by source

Source 1: Bunle (1954)

Reference	Bunle, H. (1954). <i>Le mouvement naturel de la population dans le monde de 1906 à 1936</i> . Paris: Les éditions de l'Institut national d'études démographiques (INED).
Period covered	1907-1936
Code in database	Bunle
Coverage and completeness	The deliveries resulting in stillborn children only are not included. A multiple delivery is counted only if at least one child was born alive. Data exclude the Aboriginal population.
Definitions and treatment of births by vitality	The deliveries resulting in stillborn children only are not included. A multiple delivery is counted only if at least one child was born alive. The source does not provide definitions for live-births and stillbirths.
Footnotes¹	1 - Data exclude the Aboriginal population.

Source 2: Australian Bureau of Statistics

References	Data from 1937 to 1974 come from the following Yearbooks and Demography bulletins published by the Australian Bureau of Statistics (ABS): ABS. 1939. <i>Official Year Book of the Commonwealth of Australia 1938</i>, No. 31. Chapter XIV. Vital Statistics, pp. 379-439. ABS. 1940. <i>Official Year Book of the Commonwealth of Australia 1939</i>, No. 32. Chapter XIII. Vital Statistics, pp. 287-347. ABS. 1941. <i>Official Year Book of the Commonwealth of Australia 1940</i>, No. 33. Chapter XXI. Vital Statistics, pp. 578-639. ABS. 1942. <i>Official Year Book of the Commonwealth of Australia 1941</i>, No. 34. Chapter XIII. Vital Statistics, pp. 308-367. ABS. 1944. <i>Official Year Book of the Commonwealth of Australia 1942 and 1943</i>, No. 35. Chapter XIII. Vital Statistics, pp. 316-374. ABS. 1944. <i>Demography Bulletin No. 60 - 1942</i>. Chapter III - Births, pp. 15-28. ABS. 1945. <i>Demography Bulletin No. 61 - 1943</i>. Chapter III - Births, pp. 15-32. ABS. 1947. <i>Official Year Book of the Commonwealth of Australia 1944 and 1945</i>, No. 36. Chapter XV. Vital Statistics, pp. 510-579. ABS. 1947. <i>Demography Bulletin No. 63 - 1945</i>. Chapter IV - Births, pp. 37-54. ABS. 1949. <i>Official Year Book of the Commonwealth of Australia 1946 and 1947</i>, No. 37. Chapter XVII. Vital Statistics, pp. 742-807. ABS. 1949. <i>Demography Bulletin No. 65 - 1947</i>. Chapter IV - Births, pp. 42-61. ABS. 1950. <i>Official Year Book of the Commonwealth of Australia 1951</i>, No. 38. Chapter XIV. Vital Statistics, pp. 587-650. ABS. 1951. <i>Demography Bulletin No. 67 - 1949</i>. Chapter IV - Births, pp. 42-61. ABS. 1952. <i>Official Year Book of the Commonwealth of Australia 1953</i>, No. 39. Chapter XIV. Vital Statistics, pp. 575-643. ABS. 1954. <i>Official Year Book of the Commonwealth of Australia 1954</i>, No. 40. Chapter X. Vital Statistics, pp. 377-428. ABS. 1954. <i>Demography Bulletin No. 70 - 1952</i>. Chapter IV - Births, pp. 45-65. ABS. 1955. <i>Official Year Book of the Commonwealth of Australia 1955</i>, No. 41.
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¹ Number indicated in the variable *Footnotes*.

	ABS. 1956. <i>Official Year Book of the Commonwealth of Australia 1956</i>, No. 42. Chapter XVII. Vital Statistics, pp. 623-666. ABS. 1957. <i>Official Year Book of the Commonwealth of Australia 1957</i>, No. 43. Chapter XVII. Vital Statistics, pp. 585-626. ABS. 1958. <i>Official Year Book of the Commonwealth of Australia 1958</i>, No. 44. Chapter XVII. Vital Statistics, pp. 609-650. ABS. 1959. <i>Official Year Book of the Commonwealth of Australia 1959</i>, No. 45. Chapter X. Vital Statistics, pp. 323-366. ABS. 1960. <i>Official Year Book of the Commonwealth of Australia 1960</i>, No. 46. Chapter X. Vital Statistics, pp. 329-372. ABS. 1961. <i>Official Year Book of the Commonwealth of Australia 1961</i>, No. 47. Chapter X. Vital Statistics, pp. 333-376. ABS. 1962. <i>Official Year Book of the Commonwealth of Australia 1962</i>, No. 48. Chapter X. Vital Statistics, pp. 319-362. ABS. 1963. <i>Official Year Book of the Commonwealth of Australia 1963</i>, No. 49. Chapter X. Vital Statistics, pp. 355-398. ABS. 1964. <i>Official Year Book of the Commonwealth of Australia 1964</i>, No. 50. Chapter X. Vital Statistics, pp. 311-354. ABS. 1965. <i>Official Year Book of the Commonwealth of Australia 1965</i>, No. 51. Chapter X. Vital Statistics, pp. 303-346. ABS. 1966. <i>Official Year Book of the Commonwealth of Australia 1966</i>, No. 52. Chapter 9. Vital Statistics, pp. 229-271. ABS. 1967. <i>Official Year Book of the Commonwealth of Australia 1967</i>, No. 53. Chapter 9. Vital Statistics, pp. 211-256. ABS. 1968. <i>Official Year Book of the Commonwealth of Australia 1968</i>, No. 54. Chapter 8. Vital Statistics, pp. 175-218. ABS. 1969. <i>Official Year Book of the Commonwealth of Australia 1969</i>, No. 55. Chapter 8. Vital Statistics, pp. 163-206. ABS. 1970. <i>Official Year Book of the Commonwealth of Australia 1970</i>, No. 56. Chapter 8. Vital Statistics, pp. 159-192. ABS. 1971. <i>Official Year Book of the Commonwealth of Australia 1971</i>, No. 57. Chapter 8. Vital Statistics, pp. 153-186. ABS. 1972. <i>Official Year Book of the Commonwealth of Australia 1972</i>, No. 58. Chapter 8. Vital Statistics, pp. 161-190. ABS. 1974. <i>Official Year Book of Australia 1973</i>, No. 59. Chapter 8. Vital Statistics, pp. 161-190. ABS. 1975. <i>Official Year Book of Australia 1974</i>, No. 60. Chapter 8. Vital Statistics, pp. 171-204. ABS. 1976. <i>Official Year Book of Australia 1975 and 1976</i>, No. 61. Chapter 8. Vital Statistics, pp. 173-206. Data from 1975 onwards: ABS. "Confinements, by plurality, by State". Available online: https://explore.data.abs.gov.au/vis?tm=births&pg=0&df[ds]=PEOPLE_TOPICS&df[id]=CONFINEMENTS_PLURALITY&df[ag]=ABS&df[vs]=1.0.0&hc[Measure]=Births&pd=2020%2C2020&dq=1...A&fc=Plurality Accessed: 27/06/2022 Data provided under licence Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International: https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/
Period covered	1937-2020

Code in database	ABS
Coverage and completeness	Data include only the confinements where at least one child was born alive (i.e., the confinements resulting in stillborn children only are excluded). <u>Data from 1937 to 1974:</u> In Australia, vital statistics are compiled from information supplied by State and Territorial authorities regarding the registration of births, deaths and marriages which took place within their own State or Territory. Each State and Territory has an independent system of registration. Totals for Australia presented in the <i>Yearbooks</i> and <i>Demography Bulletins</i> are the sum of the data from the States and Territories. Statistics refer to births registered by the different State and Territorial registrars during the year concerned by each volume. This means that the number of births reported and registered in a given year can include births that occurred in previous years. Information concerning a birth is required to be supplied within 28 days in the Australian Capital Territory and the Northern Territory, 42 days in South Australia, and 60 days in other States. The differentiation between single and multiple births cannot be regarded as completely accurate, as some States had different registration procedures. Thus, it is possible that in some cases where one child only of a multiple pregnancy was live born, the confinement has been treated as a single birth. However, the numbers of multiple births are not significantly affected. Data exclude the Aboriginal population ("full-blood Aborigines") until (and including) the year 1966. There are no data available for the year 1973. <u>Data from 1975 onwards:</u> Birth statistics published by the ABS are sourced from birth registration systems administered by state and territory <i>Registrars of Births, Deaths and Marriages</i>, based on data provided on a registration form completed by the parent(s) of the child. Registration of births is compulsory in Australia under relevant State/Territory legislation. Births data include: • all live born births registered in Australia that have not been previously registered; • births to temporary visitors to Australia; • births occurring within Australian Territorial waters; • births occurring in Australian Antarctic Territories and other external territories; • births occurring in the Indian Ocean territories of Christmas Island and Cocos (Keeling) Islands from 1993. These territories have been included as part of geographic Australia since 1993 as a result of an amendment made in 1992 to section 17(a) of the Acts Interpretation Act 1901-1973 (Commonwealth); • births occurring on Norfolk Island from 1 July 2016. This is due to the introduction of the Norfolk Island Legislation Amendment Act 2015. Births

	occurring on Norfolk Island prior to 1 July 2016 were not in scope for birth statistics; • births occurring in transit (i.e. on ships or planes) if registered in the Australian state or territory of 'next port of call'; • births to Australian nationals employed overseas at Australian legations and consular offices (i.e. children born overseas to Australian diplomats or their families); • births that occurred in earlier years that have not been previously registered (late registrations). Due to lags in registration of births and the provision of that information to the ABS from State and Territory <i>Registries of Births, Deaths and Marriages</i>, data on births provided by the ABS are presented on a year of registration basis, unless otherwise stated. Registration lags can be caused by either a delay by the parent(s) in submitting a completed form to the registry, or a delay by the registry in processing the birth. Births that occur in November and December are also likely to be registered in the following year. This means that the number of births reported and registered in a given year can include births that occurred in previous years (for example, of the 294,369 births registered in 2020, 87.4% occurred in 2020, while 9.1% occurred in 2019 and the remainder occurred in 2018 or earlier years). The scope for each reference year of the Birth Registrations collection includes: • births registered in the reference year and received by the ABS in the reference year; • births registered in the reference year and received by the ABS in the first quarter of the subsequent year; • from 2007, births registered in the years prior to the reference year but not received by the ABS until the reference year or the first quarter of the subsequent year, provided that these records have not been included in any statistics from earlier periods; • before 2007, births registered during the two years prior to the reference year but not received by the ABS until the reference year. A small number of twin and higher order births from the same confinement have been registered in different reference years. Because of this, the number of twin and higher order births registered in a reference year may not match the number of such confinements registered in that year.
Definitions and treatment of births by vitality	Data on births by plurality provided by the Australian Bureau of Statistics include only the confinements where at least one child was born alive (i.e., the confinements resulting in stillborn children only are excluded). A multiple birth is a confinement which results in two or more children, at least one of which is live-born. <u>Live births:</u> Consistent with the United Nations Statistical Division (UNSD) recommendations, the ABS defines a live birth as the complete expulsion or

	extraction from its mother of a product of conception, irrespective of the duration of pregnancy, which after such separation, breathes or shows any other evidence of life, such as beating of the heart, pulsation of the umbilical cord or definite movement of voluntary muscles, whether or not the umbilical cord has been cut or the placenta is attached; each product of such a birth is considered live born. <u>Stillbirths:</u> Before 1969, a stillbirth was defined as an infant not born alive, of at least seven months gestation in New South Wales and 28 weeks in other States and Territories. From 1969, a stillbirth is defined as an infant not born alive, of at least 28 weeks gestation in all States and Territories. <u>Confinement:</u> Confinements are the number of pregnancies resulting in at least one live birth. A multiple birth is a confinement which results in two or more children, at least one of which is live-born.
Footnotes¹	1 - Data exclude the Aboriginal population ("full-blood Aborigines") until (and including) the year 1966. 2 - The differentiation between single and multiple births cannot be regarded as completely accurate, as some States had different registration procedures. 3 - In the database, the column <i>Triplet_deliveries</i> corresponds to the deliveries of triplets and more children, as it is not possible to distinguish between the number of deliveries of triplets and the number of deliveries of quadruplets or more children in the original data source. In consequence, the number of multiple children estimated in the HMBD may be slightly underestimated, as the column <i>Triplet_deliveries</i> is multiplied by 3 to obtain the number of triplets and more multiple children. Nevertheless, this underestimation is negligible, as, in any given year, triplets usually constitute the majority (96%-100%) of births among triplets, quadruplets and more multiple children.
Further information	All information presented here on ABS Births data were extracted from: ABS. 2020. "Births, Australia methodology": https://www.abs.gov.au/methodologies/births-australia-methodology/2020 (Accessed: 27/06/2022) See this link to obtain further details on Births data provided by the ABS.